

# Good News / Shepherds / Finale

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

## CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

### SCENE 12 — GOOD NEWS / SHEPHERDS / FINALE

#### CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 11

*No blackout.*

*The baby has cried. The world has gone still.*

*Mary has invited Joseph closer and placed the child into his arms.*

*Do not restart the scene emotionally. We begin inside the silence Scene 11 created.*

*Joseph looks down at the child.*

*Mary watches him.*

*Another small sound from the baby.*

#### MARY

You're good at that.

*Joseph barely looks up.*

#### JOSEPH

I have no idea what I'm doing.

#### MARY

Neither does he.

*Joseph looks at the child again.*

*A tiny smile.*

#### JOSEPH

Then we'll learn together.

*No declaration of ownership. No explanation of the arc.*

*Joseph adjusts the cloth around the child with extraordinary care.*

*The man who once said, "The child... it's not mine," now answers that wound through presence and responsibility.*

## "SILENT NIGHT"

*Only now does the quiet musical phrase from Scene 11 continue.*

*One voice.*

*Then another.*

*No full choir. No applause-oriented solo.*

*Mary, Joseph and the child remain the center.*

*Anna may remain just outside the family image.*

*As the music continues, a separate pool of darkness slowly appears elsewhere.*

*The manger remains visible.*

## **THE SHEPHERD FIELD**

*Night. Cold. Open land.*

*The LED is environmental here: a wide, dark horizon, distant suggestion of Bethlehem, no supernatural imagery yet.*

*Shepherd 1, Shepherd 2 and the Young Shepherd are working. They are not waiting reverently for a Bible story to happen.*

*The Young Shepherd tries to redirect a stubborn sheep.*

### **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

Come on.

*Nothing.*

### **SHEPHERD 2**

Having trouble?

### **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

A little.

### **SHEPHERD 2**

It's a sheep.

### **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

I know.

*Shepherd 1 redirects the animal.*

### **SHEPHERD 1**

Don't argue with sheep.

### **SHEPHERD 2**

You won't win.

*The Young Shepherd pulls the cloak tighter.*

### **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

I'm cold.

**SHEPHERD 2**

We're all cold.

**SHEPHERD 1**

Morning will come.

**YOUNG SHEPHERD**

Good.

*A tiny laugh.*

*Then the animals become still.*

*Shepherd 1 notices first.*

**SHEPHERD 1**

Wait.

**SHEPHERD 2**

What?

**SHEPHERD 1**

Listen.

*SILENCE.*

**SHEPHERD 2**

I don't hear anything.

**SHEPHERD 1**

Exactly.

*A low atmospheric sound begins.*

*The Young Shepherd looks into the changing darkness.*

**YOUNG SHEPHERD**

What's that?

**SHEPHERD 1**

Stay close.

**HEAVEN INTERRUPTS**

*This is the production's largest supernatural transformation.*

*The familiar horizon begins to lose its physical logic. Haze reveals immense architecture made by light. The LED no longer behaves like landscape; depth becomes impossible. Sound expands beyond the apparent stage.*

*Avoid literal giant angels, clouds, wings, galaxies, or a video illustration of heaven.*

**ANGEL VOICE**

Do not be afraid.

*The shepherds freeze.*

**SHEPHERD 2**

I'm trying.

*A nervous breath of laughter may release, then disappears.*

**ANGEL VOICE**

I bring you good news of great joy for all people.

*The shepherds listen.*

**ANGEL VOICE**

Tonight, in the city of David, a Savior has been born.

*Beat.*

**ANGEL VOICE**

You will know Him by this sign: you will find a baby wrapped in cloth, lying in a manger.

**YOUNG SHEPHERD**

A manger?

*HEAVEN EXPANDS.*

*For one concentrated moment, use the production's full supernatural vocabulary: dimensional light through haze, transformed LED space, spatial sound and heavenly voices.*

**HEAVENLY VOICES**

GLORY TO GOD IN THE HIGHEST!

*Powerful. Brief.*

*EVERYTHING STOPS.*

*Night returns.*

*The ordinary horizon becomes recognizable again.*

*SILENCE.*

*The three shepherds stare at the place where the impossible just happened.*

**SHEPHERD 2**

Did that really happen?

**SHEPHERD 1**

Yes.

*The Young Shepherd looks toward Bethlehem.*

**YOUNG SHEPHERD**

Let's go.

**SHEPHERD 2**

Right now?

*Shepherd 1 looks toward Bethlehem.*

## **SHEPHERD 1**

Right now.

*They choose the road before they understand the whole story.*

*They move.*

## **THE SEARCH**

### **SHEPHERD UNDERSCORE**

*Bethlehem reappears around them: narrow passages, sleeping households, travelers, closed doors.*

*The supernatural light does not follow them. They must now walk through an ordinary city.*

## **SHEPHERD 2**

How do we find one baby in Bethlehem?

## **SHEPHERD 1**

Remember the sign.

## **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

A manger.

## **SHEPHERD 2**

So we're looking for a baby where babies usually aren't.

*The Young Shepherd sees Eli's property.*

## **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

There!

*They hurry.*

## **KNOCK. KNOCK.**

*Eli opens the door, exhausted.*

## **INNKEEPER ELI**

Yes?

## **SHEPHERD 1**

Forgive us. We're looking for a baby.

## **INNKEEPER ELI**

A baby?

## **SHEPHERD 2**

Born tonight.

## **INNKEEPER ELI**

There are quite a few people in Bethlehem tonight.

**SHEPHERD 1**

An angel sent us.

*Eli stops.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

An angel?

**SHEPHERD 2**

That's what we said.

**INNKEEPER ELI**

What did he tell you?

**SHEPHERD 1**

That we'd find a baby wrapped in cloth—

**YOUNG SHEPHERD**

In a manger.

*Beat.*

*Eli looks toward the rear of the property.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

A manger.

*He understands enough.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

Come with me.

*They start.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

Quietly.

*The shepherds enter.*

**THE SHEPHERDS ARRIVE**

*Eli leads them toward the animal shelter.*

*Their excitement becomes uncertainty as they realize they are approaching a sleeping family, not a palace.*

*Joseph hears footsteps and rises.*

**JOSEPH**

Eli?

**INNKEEPER ELI**

It's all right.

*Joseph sees the shepherds.*

**INNKEEPER ELI**

They came looking for the baby.

*Joseph looks at Mary.*

*Then at the strangers.*

**JOSEPH**

Why?

*Shepherd 1 takes a small step forward.*

**SHEPHERD 1**

We were told we'd find Him here.

*Joseph does not understand.*

*Eli steps aside.*

*The shepherds enter.*

*The Young Shepherd sees the feeding trough.*

*Stops.*

**YOUNG SHEPHERD**

The manger.

*Shepherd 1 sees the child.*

*SILENCE.*

*No angelic lighting returns.*

*No supernatural underscore tells them how to feel.*

*They have found an ordinary baby in an ordinary feeding trough—and the sign is exactly right.*

**AT THE MANGER**

*Mary watches these strangers carefully.*

**MARY**

How did you know?

**SHEPHERD 1**

An angel came to us.

*Mary and Joseph exchange a look.*

**SHEPHERD 2**

He said a Savior had been born tonight.

**SHEPHERD 1**

And that we'd find Him here.

*The Young Shepherd looks at the manger.*

## **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

We found Him.

*SILENCE.*

*Mary looks at the child.*

*She did not tell these men.*

*She did not persuade them.*

*She did not defend herself.*

*They came already carrying confirmation.*

*THE SHEPHERDS RESPOND*

## **SHEPHERD 1**

I'm glad we came.

*Mary looks at him.*

## **MARY**

So am I.

## **THE NAME**

*The Young Shepherd looks at the child.*

*Then at Joseph.*

## **YOUNG SHEPHERD**

What's His name?

*SILENCE.*

*Give this time.*

*Joseph looks at the child.*

*Then Mary.*

*Mary looks back at Joseph.*

*The angel gave Joseph this responsibility. Now he accepts it publicly.*

*Joseph picks up the baby from Mary and turns toward the shepherds.*

## **JOSEPH**

His name is.....

**Music suspends...**

## **JOSEPH**

Jesus.

**Music hold**

*The Young Shepherd kneels first.*

*Shepherd 1 follows.*

*Shepherd 2 slowly kneels.*

**Music orchestra is playing**

*NIA AND SIMON RETURN*

*A warm pool of light appears downstage.*

*NIA and SIMON step into it.*

*Behind them, Mary, Joseph, Jesus, and the kneeling shepherds remain visible.*

*The orchestra continues softly underneath.*

**NIA**

Remember Nazareth?

**SIMON**

Small town. Ordinary people.

**NIA**

Mary thought she knew what came next.

**SIMON**

Joseph did too.

*Beat.*

**NIA**

But that night...

everything changed forever.

*The STAR begins to intensify.*

**SIMON**

People were coming from near—

**NIA**

—and far—

**SIMON**

to see the miracle that had taken place.

**SIMON**

A child had been born.

**NIA**

A promise had been fulfilled.

**SIMON**

And a Savior had come.

*Beat.*

*Nia looks at Simon.*

*Simon looks toward the manger.*

*Then together, they turn toward the audience.*

## **NIA & SIMON**

And from one small town, through ordinary people who chose to trust God... the world would never be the same.

## **MUSIC SWELLS IMMEDIATELY.**

## **THE COMPANY RETURNS**

*As the Wise Men begin their journey through the audience, a familiar sound appears almost beneath perception.*

*OHHH-OH... 000H-00H-00H...*

*The musical DNA of Scene 1.*

*Mary's friends emerge: Shira, Talia, Adina, Dafna.*

*Joseph's friends: Levi, Malachi, Caleb, Ezra.*

*Then children, villagers, dancers, praise team and choir.*

*They are not literally entering Bethlehem.*

*They are the company telling the story.*

*Do not rebuild Nazareth.*

*The manger remains visible and central.*

## **FINAL MUSICAL NUMBER — “WELCOME TO NAZARETH” TRANSFORMED**

*The opening musical identity becomes unmistakable.*

## **COMPANY**

*OHHH-OH... 000H-00H-00H...*

*The audience recognizes where the story began.*

*At the opening, the musical idea meant: Welcome to an ordinary place.*

*Now it means: Look what began in an ordinary place.*

*Build the finale as one continuous arrangement rather than a sequence of separate reprises.*

## **THREE WISE MEN APPEAR IN THE AISLES.**

*Each carries a gift.*

*They begin a slow, dignified procession down the aisle towards the stage*

*Nia and Simon watch them for a moment.*

## **FINALE BUILD — ONE MUSICAL SPINE**

*Children and Nia/Simon begin with recognizable Scene 1 movement vocabulary: baskets, fabric, claps, and simple traveling patterns.*

*Mary's and Joseph's friends layer into the architecture. Their presence carries their journeys; no dialogue explains who believed, doubted, or changed.*

*The shepherds rise and join the musical celebration.*

*The Wise Men continue their slow procession toward the stage.*

*Inside the "Welcome to Nazareth" arrangement, brief musical memories surface organically*

*A restrained "Chosen" phrase – once Mary's private question, now heard in a larger community.*

*A brief "My Beloved / Still Yours" instrumental color – Mary and Joseph see one another across the manger.*

*A "Walk With You" figure – the promise has changed from certainty about the road to choosing to continue walking.*

*Do not stop the finale to announce these callbacks. They should be discoveries inside the same musical river.*

## **THE WISE MEN / VISUAL EXPANSION**

*The Wise Men reach the stage during the musical build.*

*Their gifts may be presented ceremonially without dialogue.*

*Shepherds and Wise Men occupy different visual territories: different people, different journeys, same child.*

*Avoid allowing the procession to block Mary, Joseph, or Jesus.*

## **THE DANCE CELEBRATION**

*The music opens into the final choreographic celebration.*

*Use the strongest Scene 1 movement DNA in transformed form: traveling diagonals, turns, layered levels, partner movement where appropriate, fabric, baskets, lanterns, rhythmic tool accents and age-appropriate children's movement.*

*Mary and Joseph do not join the full-out choreography.*

*They have earned stillness.*

*The world moves around them.*

*The LED may now echo the distinctive Nazareth horizon from Scene 1, transformed and widened—not as a literal return to town, but as a visual memory of where this story began.*

## **FINAL VOCAL BUILD**

*Children join vocally.*

*Friends.*

*Shepherds.*

*Praise Team / Choir.*

*Full Company.*

*The arrangement reaches the production's largest musical scale.*

*The title idea "CHOSEN" may become the final resolved sung thought, but it should emerge from the established finale rather than feel attached as a second ending.*

*No spoken explanation follows it.*

## **FINAL SUNG STATEMENT.**

## **FINAL CHORD.**

## **THE SPECTACLE SURRENDERS**

*Do not freeze immediately into a crowded Christmas card.*

*Over the final sustained musical and lighting counts, simplify.*

*Dancers finish their final traveling phrase and become still.*

*Outer movement stops.*

*The company's eyelines begin returning toward the child.*

*The LED's movement slows.*

*The strongest peripheral light reduces.*

*The audience's eye is deliberately guided inward.*

## **FINAL IMAGE**

*Mary, Joseph and Jesus remain low and central.*

*The Young Shepherd may kneel nearest the family.*

*Shepherds occupy one side.*

*Wise Men occupy the opposite side, gifts visible.*

*Nia and Simon remain offset and visible without competing for focus.*

*Friends, children, villagers, praise team and company form layered heights farther out.*

*Dancers frame the outer picture.*

*Warm gold and deep night-blue may remain in the larger environment, with the star visible above.*

*Then the outer world reduces another degree.*

*What remains emotionally is*

**MARY.**

**JOSEPH.**

**JESUS.**

*No narration.*

*No sermon.*

*No "Merry Christmas."*

*No adult-Jesus montage.*

*No crucifixion or resurrection imagery.*

*The manger is enough.*

*HOLD.*

*One.*

*Two.*

*Three.*

*FAST, CLEAN BLACKOUT.*

**END OF CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER**